

EA and HERM adoption survey of the EUNIS EA SIG

Welcome!

This survey explores the current adoption and use of Enterprise Architecture (EA) and the [Higher Education Reference Model \(HERM\)](#) in higher education, including practices, use cases, barriers, and support needs. The study is conducted in close connection with the [EUNIS Enterprise Architecture Special Interest Group \(EA SIG\)](#), which promotes knowledge sharing and collaborative development of EA practices across higher education. The findings will be discussed with the EA SIG and used to support further community activities and publications.

Privacy and Data Protection

Participation in this survey is voluntary.
The data controller responsible for the processing of personal data is:

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Represented by **Markus von der Heyde, CEO**.
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The information collected through this survey will be used to analyse the adoption and use of Enterprise Architecture (EA) and the Higher Education Reference Model (HERM) in higher education. The study will be analysed by Markus von der Heyde on behalf of SemaLogic, discussed with the EUNIS Enterprise Architecture SIG, and subsequently published.

The legal basis for processing personal data is your consent pursuant to Art. 6(1)(a) GDPR. Contact details and other direct personal identifiers will not be included in the published research dataset. Exception: if you opt in to peer matching, your contact details will be shared only with peer institutions that have also opted in.

Before publication, the survey data will be pseudonymised. The resulting dataset is intended to be published for long-term public access through the Zenodo community "[Research on Digital Transformation and Information Technology in Higher Education in Europe](#)". The published data may be downloaded, analysed and reused by third parties in accordance with the licence specified for the Zenodo record (CC-BY-NC-SA 4.0).

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Under the GDPR, you may also have the right to request access to, correction or deletion of your personal data, restriction of processing, and data portability. You have the right to lodge a complaint with a competent data protection supervisory authority.

1. How would you like to proceed?*

Please select one option:

☐ Leave the survey without participating. You may optionally tell us why on the final page.
☐ Preview the questionnaire only. My responses will not be included in the study.
☐ Participate in the survey. I have read the information above and voluntarily consent to the processing of my survey responses for the purposes described.

Respondent & Institution Profile

2. Institution name

If you prefer not to identify your institution, leave this field blank.

3. Country

Which country is your institution based in?

☐ AD - Andorra
☐ AL - Shqipëria
☐ AT - Österreich
☐ BA - Bosna i Hercegovina / Босна и Херцеговина
☐ BE - België / Belgique / Belgien
☐ BG - България
☐ BY - Беларусь
☐ CH - Schweiz / Suisse / Svizzera / Svizra
☐ CZ - Česko
☐ DE - Deutschland
☐ DK - Danmark
☐ EE - Eesti
☐ ES - España
☐ FI - Suomi / Finland
☐ FR - France
☐ GB - United Kingdom
☐ GR - Ελλάδα
☐ HR - Hrvatska
☐ HU - Magyarország
☐ IE - Éire / Ireland
☐ IS - Ísland
☐ IT - Italia
☐ LI - Liechtenstein
☐ LT - Lietuva
☐ LU - Lëtzebuerg / Luxembourg / Luxemburg
☐ LV - Latvija
☐ MC - Monaco
☐ MD - Moldova
☐ ME - Crna Gora / Црна Гора
☐ MK - Северна Македонија / Maqedonia e Veriut
☐ MT - Malta
☐ NL - Nederland
☐ NO - Norge / Noreg
☐ PL - Polska
☐ PT - Portugal
☐ RO - România
☐ RS - Србија / Srbija
☐ RU - Россия
☐ SE - Sverige
☐ SI - Slovenija
☐ SK - Slovensko
☐ SM - San Marino
☐ UA - Україна
☐ VA - Città del Vaticano
☐ Other (please specify below)

4. Specific Country

Please state the country in which your institution is based.

5. Institution type

☐ University of Applied Sciences / Polytechnic
☐ Arts or Music institution
☐ Specialised higher education institution
☐ Research institution
☐ University
☐ Don't know / Cannot assess
☐ Other

6. Approximate number of students

Report head count.

☐ Fewer than 1,000
☐ 1,000–4,999
☐ 5,000–9,999
☐ 10,000–19,999
☐ 20,000–39,999
☐ 40,000–79,999
☐ 80,000 or more
☐ Not applicable
☐ Don't know

7. Approximate staff headcount

☐ Fewer than 250
☐ 250–999
☐ 1,000–2,499
☐ 2,500–4,999
☐ 5,000–9,999
☐ 10,000 or more
☐ Don't know

8. Your role

☐	Enterprise / Business / Solution / IT Architect
☐	IT Strategy / Digital Strategy
☐	CIO / IT Director / Head of IT
☐	CDO / Digital Office
☐	IT or Digital Project / Programme Management
☐	Academic / Researcher with EA context
☐	Educator / Lecturer with EA context
☐	Other

9. Your organisational unit

In which part of your institution do you mainly work?

☐	Central IT
☐	Central administration or services outside IT (incl. executive or strategy office)
☐	Decentralised IT in a faculty, department or institute
☐	Faculty, department or institute (outside IT)
☐	External to the institution (e.g. consultant)
☐	Other

10. Your knowledge of your institution's EA practice

☐	I am directly responsible for or actively involved in it
☐	I work closely with the EA practice
☐	I have general knowledge of it
☐	I have limited knowledge of it

Enterprise Architecture Practice

11. Current status of Enterprise Architecture at your institution

To the best of your knowledge, what is the current status of Enterprise Architecture at your institution?

If the status differs between parts of your institution (e.g. central units vs. faculties), please answer for the most advanced part.

☐	Established operational practice
☐	Early operational practice / currently being established
☐	Exploring or planning EA
☐	No EA practice
☐	Don't know / Cannot assess

Enterprise Architecture Practice Details

12. Coverage of EA across organisational areas

In higher education, EA often covers some parts of the institution more than others.
For each of the following areas, what is the current status of EA?

	Established	Early operational	Exploring or planning	No EA	Don't know / n.a.
Central IT (e.g. IT services, infrastructure, IT governance)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Central administration and services outside IT (e.g. student administration, finance, HR)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Decentralised IT in faculties, departments or institutes	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Faculties, departments, institutes (organisation of teaching and research, local processes)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Other (please name) 	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

13. Organisational age of the EA practice

Approximately how long has your institution had an operational EA practice?

☐ Less than 1 year

☐ 1-3 years

☐ 4-7 years

☐ More than 7 years

☐ Don't know

EA approaches currently used

Which of the following frameworks/methods/etc. does your institution currently use, pilot, or actively evaluate for Enterprise Architecture?

For the following questions, you can select more than one option.

14. EA frameworks / methods

☐ Zachman Framework

☐ TOGAF

☐ Don't know / Cannot assess

☐ Other EA framework or method

15. Higher-education reference models / architectures

☐	HORA / HOSA
☐	HERM
☐	Don't know / Cannot assess
☐	Other higher-education reference model

16. Modelling languages / standards

☐	BPMN
☐	ArchiMate
☐	Don't know / Cannot assess
☐	Other modelling language or notation

17. Institution-specific approach

☐	Custom / in-house EA framework
☐	Just EA standards without customisation
☐	No formal framework; pragmatic or ad hoc EA practice
☐	Don't know / Cannot assess
☐	Other

18. Organisational home of the EA practice

Where is the EA practice organisationally located or formally anchored?

You can select more than one option.

☐	Central IT
☐	Dedicated Enterprise Architecture team
☐	Cross-institutional / distributed model
☐	Academic / teaching organisation
☐	Undefined
☐	CDO / Digital Office
☐	Central administration outside IT
☐	Research organisation
☐	CIO office / IT leadership
☐	Don't know / Cannot assess
☐	Other

19. Executive or organisational lead for EA

Who has primary organisational responsibility for Enterprise Architecture?

☐	CIO
☐	Dedicated Head of Enterprise Architecture / Chief Architect
☐	Distributed / shared responsibility without one formal lead
☐	Undefined
☐	Vice-President / Vice-Rector / Executive Board member
☐	CDO / Head of Digital Transformation
☐	Central administration leader outside IT
☐	IT Director / Head of IT
☐	Don't know / Cannot assess
☐	Other

HERM Awareness & Adoption

20. Respondent awareness of HERM

Before starting this survey, how familiar were you personally with HERM?

☐ I know HERM well
☐ I know the basic concept
☐ I had heard of HERM but knew little about it
☐ I was not familiar with HERM before this survey

21. Institutional HERM adoption status

To the best of your knowledge, what is the highest current level of HERM adoption at your institution?

☐ Not considered
☐ Being evaluated / considered
☐ Pilot or experimental use
☐ Active operational use
☐ Embedded in governance or standard EA processes
☐ Previously used, but no longer in use
☐ Don't know / Cannot assess

HERM Usage Details

22. Duration of HERM engagement

Approximately how long has your institution been actively evaluating or using HERM?

☐ Less than 1 year
☐ 1-3 years
☐ 4-7 years
☐ More than 7 years
☐ Don't know

23. HERM application area

In which areas of your organisation are the HERM artefacts mentioned earlier used?

☐ Teaching and learning (as topic)
☐ Institution-wide / cross-domain
☐ Governance / strategy
☐ Human resources
☐ Finance and controlling
☐ Research (as topic)
☐ IT management
☐ Facilities / infrastructure
☐ Student lifecycle / student administration
☐ Don't know / Cannot assess
☐ Other

24. HERM artefacts used or evaluated

Which HERM artefacts does your institution currently use, pilot, or actively evaluate?

	Operational	Pilot	Evaluating	Not used	Don't know / n.a.
Service Reference Model (SRM)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Data Reference Model (DRM)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Technology Reference Model (TRM)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Business Reference Model (BRM)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Application Reference Model (ARM)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

25. Additional artefacts used

Which EAM and HERM-related/supporting artefacts and approaches are in use?

☐	Business Model Canvas
☐	Value Streams
☐	Recipe Cards
☐	Process Models
☐	Don't know / Cannot assess
☐	Other

26. Primary HERM application area

Which is currently the primary area? Provide HERM Business Capability name or other HERM identifier, if known.

27. Problems and tasks addressed with HERM

For which tasks is HERM currently used or evaluated at your institution?

☐	Structuring or communicating business capabilities
☐	Structuring or documenting the application landscape
☐	Benchmarking or comparison with peer institutions
☐	Risk, security, or compliance analysis
☐	Process or responsibility modelling
☐	Strategic or transformation planning
☐	Technology standardisation or technology lifecycle management
☐	Data governance or data architecture
☐	Communication between IT and non-IT stakeholders
☐	Impact analysis and future-state planning for major change initiatives
☐	Consolidation, merger, or shared-service planning
☐	Investment or project portfolio planning and prioritisation
☐	Service design or service architecture
☐	Don't know / Cannot assess
☐	Other

28. Value received from using HERM

What specific value can you now offer your organisation?

☐ No tangible outcome yet
☐ Shared terminology
☐ Reusable architecture artefact
☐ Improved landscape transparency
☐ Accelerated project or analysis
☐ Better decision support
☐ Cost or effort reduction
☐ Improved stakeholder communication
☐ Don't know / Cannot assess
☐ Other

29. Concrete HERM use case

Please describe one specific HERM use case at your institution that you know particularly well. Please focus on what was actually done rather than on HERM in general.

You may use the following points as guidance:

- **Use case:** What was the problem, task, or decision?
- **Actors:** Who was involved?
- **HERM use:** Which HERM artefact(s) were used, and how were they applied?
- **Outcome:** What was produced, decided, or changed?
- **Benefit:** Who benefited from the result, and in what way?

A concise description is sufficient; you do not need to address every point.

30. What has worked well?

What aspects of using HERM have worked particularly well at your institution?

31. Enabling factors

What factors enabled the implementation of HERM at your institution?

☐ Strong EA capability
☐ Tool support
☐ Good documentation
☐ National / community support
☐ Executive sponsorship
☐ Active practitioner community
☐ Availability of reusable examples
☐ Individual champion or internal advocate
☐ Alignment with existing EA models
☐ Concrete institutional use case
☐ Don't know / Cannot assess
☐ Other

32. What has been difficult or missing?

What aspects of using HERM have been difficult, insufficient, or missing?

33. Integration of HERM into broader EA practice

What role does HERM play in your institution's broader EA practice?

☐ Central foundation of the EA approach
☐ Integrated component of the EA approach
☐ Selectively connected for specific use cases
☐ Used independently of the broader EA practice
☐ No relationship established yet
☐ Don't know / Cannot assess

34. Adapted, extended or mapped HERM

Have you adapted, extended or mapped HERM in a way that might be useful to other institutions?

☐ HORA mapping
☐ Tool implementation
☐ Service catalogue
☐ Translation
☐ Capability extensions
☐ Governance model
☐ Visualisation
☐ Data mapping
☐ Application mapping
☐ Don't know / Cannot assess
☐ Other

HERM Non-Adoption & Barriers

35. Reasons HERM is not currently in operational use

Which factors currently contribute to HERM not being used operationally at your institution?

☐	Insufficient internal EA capacity
☐	HERM was previously used but discontinued
☐	Lack of implementation examples / peer cases
☐	HERM does not appear to fit our institutional context
☐	Insufficient documentation or guidance
☐	Switching or adoption effort is too high
☐	Benefits are unclear compared with the required effort
☐	Existing EA approaches already meet our needs
☐	Lack of leadership or organisational support
☐	HERM is not sufficiently known at our institution
☐	No current need for an additional reference model
☐	EA/HERM knowledge depends on too few individuals
☐	HERM appears too complex for our current needs
☐	HERM appears too specific for our context
☐	Insufficient tooling support
☐	Don't know / Cannot assess
☐	Other

36. Primary barrier

Of the factors you selected, which is currently the most important barrier?

☐	Insufficient tooling support
☐	EA/HERM knowledge depends on too few individuals
☐	Lack of leadership or organisational support
☐	No current need for an additional reference model
☐	Insufficient documentation or guidance
☐	HERM does not appear to fit our institutional context
☐	Existing EA approaches already meet our needs
☐	HERM appears too complex for our current needs
☐	HERM was previously used but discontinued
☐	Insufficient internal EA capacity
☐	HERM is not sufficiently known at our institution
☐	Lack of implementation examples / peer cases
☐	HERM appears too specific for our context
☐	Switching or adoption effort is too high
☐	Benefits are unclear compared with the required effort
☐	Other (meaning the item you provided above)
☐	None of the above
☐	Don't know / Cannot assess

37. Future consideration of HERM

Is there currently an intention or plan to evaluate or pilot HERM within the next two years?

☐ Yes	☐ Under discussion	☐ No	☐ Don't know / Cannot assess
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38. Potential role of HERM

If your institution adopted HERM, what role would it most likely play?

☐	Foundation for the overall EA approach
☐	Complement to an existing EA framework or method
☐	Reference model for selected domains or use cases
☐	Primarily a benchmarking / comparison reference
☐	Don't know / Cannot assess
☐	Other

39. Requirements for future adoption

What would HERM need to offer, or what would need to change at your institution, for adoption to become more attractive?

Open Questions & Support Needs

40. Open questions about Enterprise Architecture

What are the most important unresolved questions about Enterprise Architecture at your institution?

41. Open questions about HERM

What questions about HERM would you most like the HERM community to address?

42. Support needs

What kind of support would your institution like HERM to provide to help move EA forward?

☐	None currently
☐	Mapping to other EA frameworks or standards
☐	Implementation guide / playbook
☐	Benchmarking data
☐	Concrete use cases and examples
☐	Peer exchange with other institutions
☐	Governance and organisational guidance
☐	Introductory guidance
☐	Tooling support
☐	Training or workshops
☐	Reference architectures / reusable patterns
☐	Don't know / Cannot assess
☐	Other

43. Most important support need

Which of these would be most valuable to your institution?

☐ Tooling support
☐ Reference architectures / reusable patterns
☐ Peer exchange with other institutions
☐ Introductory guidance
☐ Benchmarking data
☐ Implementation guide / playbook
☐ Training or workshops
☐ Governance and organisational guidance
☐ Concrete use cases and examples
☐ Mapping to other EA frameworks or standards
☐ Other (meaning the item you provided above)
☐ None of the above
☐ Don't know / Cannot assess

Knowledge Sharing & Follow-up

44. Potential value of the institution's experience

Do you believe your institution has an EA or HERM experience that could be useful for other higher education institutions?

☐ Yes	☐ Possibly	☐ Unlikely	☐ No	☐ Don't know / Cannot assess
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45. Interest in community exchange

Would you or your institution be interested in any of the following?

☐ Receiving the results of this survey
☐ Participating in a more detailed follow-up survey
☐ Being connected with peer institutions that have a similar EA setup (peer matching)
☐ Participating in a follow-up interview
☐ Sharing a use case or practical experience
☐ Presenting and discussing your EA / HERM work
☐ Joining a community workgroup on EA / HERM
☐ None of these

46. Contact e-mail

By providing your contact details, you consent to the purpose(s) provided in the previous question.

Please note that your response will not be included in the publication of the dataset. It will only be processed internally by SemaLogic and the EUNIS EA SIG. If you selected peer matching, your contact details will be shared only with peer institutions that have also selected peer matching.

47. Permission to name institution

You had provided the name of your institution at the beginning of this survey.
May your institution be named in publications or datasets resulting from this survey?

☐ Yes, the institution may be named	☐ No, use and publish only anonymised or aggregated information
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Closing & Feedback

Thank you for your time.
We will evaluate, discuss and publish the results as soon as possible.

48. Feedback

Do you have any final comments about the survey itself?
If you chose not to participate, we would appreciate a short note on why.

Thank you again for your personal support of the global HERM community!